



The way we shop has radically changed over the last decade. With the mushrooming of malls, branded stores and high couture outlets there is no dearth of options for the Indian consumer. With all the emerging options in variety and selection it comes as no surprise that the Indian online retail industry has also seen a radical surge in growth. With options galore for everything under the sun including furniture, electronics, books, groceries, appliances and entertainment, there is scarcely any item that can't be yours in just a few clicks. However, being of the prudent Indian consumer variety isn't all that it's cracked up to be – what about bargains? The Internet may open up new avenues of consumption but can it really replace the secret thrill of a good deal?

Many websites over the last few years have played around with providing Indian customers with everything they could ever want including bargains. The early eBay India user would remember the highly publicised auctions that inevitable went nowhere and didn't really satisfy the urge for a fairly (or unfairly) won bargain. Indian consumers are culturally drawn to getting under the radar when it comes to

Learn the tools, tips and tricks necessary to make you the best bargain-hunter you can be when shopping online.

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list prices and the Internet doesn't always seem to cooperate. But that's only because shopping smarter online is quite different from shopping in the streets. The tricks, tips and tools for really making the most from your online shopping excursion can easily be learnt and applied. These methods and suggestions will not only help you have a fun shopping experience but also save you bundles of cash in the long run.

Practical Tips: The Boring Bits First

Everyone has their own little wisdoms about shopping. But to truly be wise

in your online shopping, it's necessary to have a plan. With just a few simple planned steps you can maximise the value of your expenses and even save money down the line.

Use a Credit Card

This may seem counter-intuitive but it works. The simplest reason for credit card usage is security and liquidity. If you're hunting around for deals for your next cell phone you don't want to empty your bank account in one go due to a glitch. While debit cards are a great tool to control credit expenses, using them for online shopping purposes can put your current cash flow in jeopardy. In case of a glitch with a credit card your cash flow isn't blocked since credit card companies can stop or cancel the transaction while on debit cards the money refund is completely out of your hands.

A Single Card for Shopping

Credit cards are a double-edged sword. They allow a reasonable credit at manageable costs if used discreetly but can spiral out of control if not. But in their purest form you should assign one specific credit card just for online shopping. Not only